JPMORGAN PAYMENTS · MERCHANT SERVICES · LEADERSHIP DISCUSSION

Agentic commerce: where we play, what we build, and how we win

Market strategy, target experience, product architecture, partners and a phased plan for the Agent Commerce Gateway

AUDIENCE
Business, strategy, product, architecture and technology leads

PURPOSE
Align on where to play and approve Phase 1

DATE
October 2026

1 · MARKET
What agentic commerce is; six experiences and who plays in each

2 · WHERE TO PLAY
Pros and cons; where a PSP and bank should focus

3 · WHAT IT TAKES
Building blocks, the experience and how the parts talk, in plain terms

4 · OUR BUILD
Architecture, build versus partner, partners, the Paze and Google views

5 · PLAN
Phases, liability, issues, and what we ask and get

Agents are becoming a shopping channel. We should own the trusted path from an agent's request to a settled payment, not the agent itself

WHAT IS HAPPENING

- AI agents now shop for people in **six distinct ways**, from driving a merchant's website like a person to paying headlessly under limits the consumer set once.
- Google, OpenAI, Visa, Mastercard and Stripe have each shipped a protocol, wallet or token for it. **No one owns the end-to-end trust path.**
- Agent-specific liability rules are not settled. The authorized-but-wrong purchase lands on merchants by default.

WHERE WE SHOULD PLAY

- **Win now** in shopper-confirmed agent checkout as the processor behind it: Google AI Mode and Gemini first, ChatGPT next.
- **Differentiate** in delegated, headless purchasing, where bank-backed consent (Chase, Paze) and evidence matter most.
- **Partner** with agent wallets; **detect and label** browser agents rather than chase them.

WHAT WE WILL DO

- Build one **Agent Commerce Gateway** on UPOP, Credential Vault, Authentication Optimization and the Decision Platform. Four components are new.
- Plug in Google (UCP, Google Pay, AP2, SPA) and Paze, the bank-owned wallet run by EWS, as **entry points and credentials**, never as dependencies.
- Deliver in **four gated phases**: acceptance, delegation, optimization, scale.

WHAT IT GETS US

The execution layer for agent payments

Share of a new channel
JPMMS merchants become agent-ready by configuration, so agent orders settle with us instead of moving to another PSP.

Data to price risk
First-party approval, fraud and misexecution data on labelled agent traffic, which we do not have today.

A seat in rule-making
An evidence standard that networks need before they can write agent liability rules.

A hard-to-copy edge
Issuer and acquirer in one integration: bank-backed consent that Stripe and Adyen cannot match alone.

DECISIONS TODAY

1. Fund Phase 1 and name a protocol-edge team

2. Open partner talks: Google, Visa, Mastercard, EWS (Paze), one agent platform

3. Agree one JPMMS–Chase position on agent liability before any network forum

The ask for this group is on page 22: fund Phase 1, open five partner conversations, and agree one JPMMS–Chase liability position.

Agentic commerce means software acting for a person decides or executes part of a purchase. Payments only changes once the agent presses "pay"

A five-level autonomy ladder. Levels 0 and 1 change marketing and search. **From level 2 upward, the payer is no longer the person at the keyboard**, which is where a PSP's job changes.

Autonomy grows →

	LEVEL 0 Assist	LEVEL 1 Prepare	LEVEL 2 Confirm	LEVEL 3 Delegate	LEVEL 4 Autonomous
	Agent researches and recommends	Agent builds the cart; person checks out as usual	Agent checks out; person confirms each payment	Agent pays within limits set once; person handles exceptions only	Agents pay agents, APIs or data per use; no person per transaction
Who presses pay	Person	Person	Agent, after the person confirms	Agent, inside a standing permission	Agent or machine
What payments sees	Ordinary checkout	Ordinary checkout	Wallet token from an agent surface	Agent-bound token, no person present	Stablecoin, account-to-account or virtual card

Where we focus: levels 2 and 3, including recurring purchases set up at level 3. Level 4 is watched, not built for: much of it is moving to stablecoin and account-to-account rails.

Levels adapted for this deck; industry sources use similar 4–5 step scales. Level 4 is emerging and mostly outside card rails today.

The market is running six distinct experiences. They differ in who acts, how the agent pays, and whether the merchant even knows an agent is buying

P1 · LEVEL 2–3 — LIVE

Agent drives the website

The agent operates the merchant's normal checkout like a person: clicks, forms, saved card or a one-time card. The merchant sees an ordinary web order, often flagged as a bot.

Examples: OpenAI agent mode, Perplexity Comet, Amazon Buy for Me, Crossmint Agent Checkouts

P2 · LEVEL 2 — LIVE

In-chat checkout, shopper confirms

The agent calls the merchant's checkout through a protocol; the shopper confirms with a wallet inside the chat. The merchant receives an identified agent order through an API.

Examples: Google AI Mode and Gemini (UCP + Google Pay), ChatGPT (ACP + Shared Payment Tokens), Perplexity with PayPal

P3 · LEVEL 2–3 — PILOTING

Agent wallet, per-purchase budget

The consumer stores a card with an agent wallet and approves a budget for each purchase. The agent pays with a scoped one-time card or a network agentic token.

Examples: Crossmint order intents, Link one-time cards (used by the shopping agent Instinct), Visa Intelligent Commerce and Mastercard Agent Pay credentials

P4 · LEVEL 3 — PILOTING

Headless delegated purchasing

The consumer delegates once, with limits. The agent buys inside them with no checkout screen; anything outside the limits asks the consumer. This is the design we have been developing.

Examples: AP2 intent mandates, network agentic tokens with consumer controls, our Agent Commerce Gateway

P5 · LEVEL 3 — PILOTING

Agent-managed recurring and replenishment

The agent sets up or manages subscriptions and auto-reorders ("coffee under $40 a month"); the merchant charges later as merchant-initiated transactions.

Examples: replenishment and subscription-management agents; AP2 intent mandates for future purchases

P6 · LEVEL 4 — EMERGING

Machine-to-machine and agent-to-agent

Agents pay APIs, data or other agents per call, or a buyer's agent negotiates with a merchant's agent. Often settles outside card rails.

Examples: Coinbase x402 stablecoin payments, pay-per-crawl, A2A and PAP agent-to-business sessions, B2B procurement agents

Crossmint shows how one provider can span several patterns: card vault (P3), budget approval with a passkey (P3), network agentic tokens first with an encrypted-card fallback (P3/P4), browser checkout when no API exists (P1), and stablecoin wallets (P6).

KEY TERMS **PSP** payment processor **Wallet** where a person's cards are stored **Token** stand-in card number **Agentic token** a token only one agent can use **Protocol** shared language between agent, merchant and payments **Mandate** signed permission **Full glossary** page 25

Source: public product announcements and documentation (Google, OpenAI, Perplexity, Amazon, Visa, Mastercard, Stripe, Crossmint sample app and API), as of Oct 2026. Status labels are indicative.

Six layers of players formed in under two years, but no one yet owns the trusted path that runs through all of them

Agent experiences Where the shopper talks to an agent	OpenAI ChatGPT · Google Gemini and AI Mode · Perplexity · Anthropic Claude · Meta AI · Amazon Alexa+ and Buy for Me · Microsoft Copilot · Instinct · Sierra-built brand agents
Protocols The shared languages	**Commerce:** UCP (Google, Shopify), ACP (OpenAI, Stripe), PAP (Meta, Sierra) · **Authority:** AP2 mandates (now FIDO Alliance) · **Identity:** Visa TAP, Mastercard Agent Pay · **Transport:** MCP, A2A · **Machine pay:** x402
Wallets and agentic credentials What the agent pays with	Google Pay · PayPal · Link (Stripe) · Paze (EWS, bank-owned) · agent wallets (Crossmint and others) · network agentic tokens: Visa Intelligent Commerce, Mastercard Agent Pay
PSPs and acquirers Turn requests into payments	**Stripe** (ACP co-author, Shared Payment Tokens, Link) · **Adyen** (live Google agentic integration) · **Checkout.com** (UCP, SPA) · PayPal and Braintree · Worldpay · **JPMMS** (no public agent offer yet)
Networks and issuers Credentials, approval, rules	Visa · Mastercard · EMVCo agentic task force · issuers, including Chase, deciding how to authenticate and approve agent payments
Merchants and platforms Sell and fulfil	Commerce platforms (Shopify and others) bundling agent readiness · large retailers (Walmart, Target, others) building their own agents · the long tail, which cannot implement protocols alone
Why now Milestones, public	**2025** Visa and Mastercard launch agent tokens; ACP and AP2 published · **Jan 2026** UCP live in Gemini and AI Mode · **Apr 2026** AP2 moves to the FIDO Alliance · **2026** Google previews a multi-merchant Universal Cart · **Oct 2026** Meta and Sierra announce PAP

THE GAP

Every layer solves its own piece. No one checks, on every payment, that

- the consumer's **authority** covers this purchase,
- the credential is **eligible** for it, and
- there is **evidence** to settle a dispute.

WHO IS MOVING FASTEST

Stripe spans protocol (ACP), credential (Link, Shared Payment Tokens) and processing. **Google** owns the surface and a protocol. **Networks** own agent identity and tokens.

OUR OPENING

Sit at the PSP layer with **issuer-side reach** (Chase, Paze) and make authority, eligibility and evidence checkable on every payment.

Source: public announcements and documentation as of Oct 2026. Lists are illustrative, not exhaustive; verify current status before external use.

In every pattern except browser agents, the PSP sits on the critical path, but the role changes from processing a token to deciding whether the agent may pay

PATTERN	AGENT AND SURFACE	HOW IT TALKS TO THE MERCHANT	WHAT IT PAYS WITH	WHO CARRIES TRUST TODAY	THE PSP'S ROLE
P1 Agent drives the website	ChatGPT agent mode, Comet, Buy for Me, Crossmint	Browser automation of the merchant's web checkout	Saved card, one-time virtual card	Nobody; merchant sees a bot	BYPASSED Processes an unlabelled card-not-present payment
P2 In-chat checkout, shopper confirms	Gemini, AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity	UCP or ACP checkout API	Google Pay token, Shared Payment Token, PayPal	Wallet (device authentication)	PROCESSOR Payment handler behind the protocol; labels, authenticates, authorizes
P3 Agent wallet, per-purchase budget	Instinct, apps built on Crossmint	API where available, else browser	Link one-time card, agentic token, encrypted card	Agent wallet and its passkey	ACQUIRER Often sees an ordinary card payment; little context
P4 Headless delegated purchasing	Personal agents (Instinct, Gemini, Claude, ChatGPT)	UCP + AP2, ACP, direct API, TAP-signed requests	Agent-bound network token or Paze payload, cryptogram per purchase	Unclear: issuer, network, wallet or PSP	EXECUTION LAYER Validates authority, picks an eligible credential, executes, keeps evidence
P5 Agent-managed recurring	Same as P4	Subscription or order APIs	Card on file; merchant-initiated charges	Merchant, under card-on-file rules	LIFECYCLE OWNER Ties each later charge to the original authority; tokens and account updater
P6 Machine-to-machine	Developer agents, API marketplaces	HTTP 402 (x402), A2A, PAP	Stablecoin, account-to-account, virtual card	Protocol and wallet	OPTIONAL Settlement and treasury, if card or bank rails are used

Implication: the PSP's value grows with autonomy. At P2 we compete on processing; at P4 and P5 we decide whether a payment is allowed at all, which is where a bank-owned PSP can be distinctive.

Source: public documentation as of Oct 2026; JPMMS analysis.

Each experience trades consumer convenience against merchant control and liability clarity. Delegated and recurring purchasing score best overall

PATTERN	CONSUMER CONVENIENCE	MERCHANT CONTROL	LIABILITY CLARITY	REPEAT BUYING	DURABILITY	BIGGEST PRO	BIGGEST CON
P1 Agent drives the website	◕	○	○	◔	◔	Works at any merchant today, with no integration	Bot detection, terms of service and breakage; merchant never opted in; disputes land on the merchant
P2 In-chat checkout, shopper confirms	◑	◕	◕	◔	●	Existing wallet and liability rules apply; live at scale on Google surfaces	A human must confirm every purchase; much volume uses cards saved to a Google account (PAN_ONLY), with no liability shift
P3 Agent wallet, per-purchase budget	◑	◔	◑	◑	◑	Fast to market; network-enforced limits where agentic tokens exist	Fallback cards carry only advisory limits; merchant sees an ordinary card payment
P4 Headless delegated purchasing	●	◕	◑	●	◕	The real promise: silent purchasing inside clear limits, with control in the bank app	Misexecution liability is unassigned; needs delegation, evidence and network rules
P5 Agent-managed recurring	◕	●	◕	●	●	Builds on mature card-on-file and merchant-initiated rules	Price rises and trial-to-paid changes need fresh consent
P6 Machine-to-machine	◔	◑	◔	◕	◔	Micro-payments that cards can't serve economically	Mostly off card rails; consumer protection and compliance still forming

Score, low to high: ○ ◔ ◑ ◕ ● (a fuller circle is better for us and the consumer) Durability = resilience to merchant terms, bot defences and pending network rules.

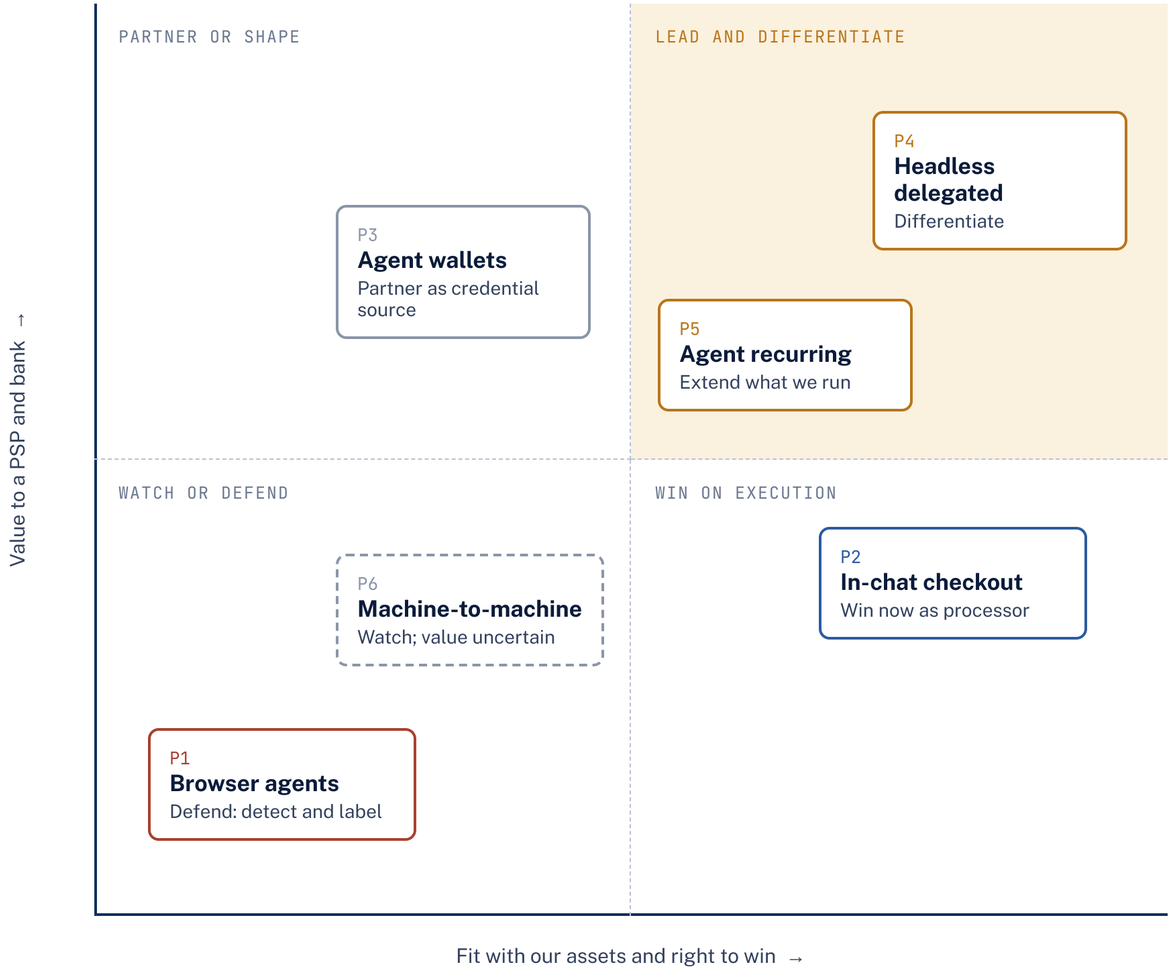
For consumers, convenience rises with autonomy, but only if limits and an off switch sit somewhere they trust.

For merchants, API-based patterns (P2, P4, P5) restore control and visibility that browser agents take away.

For us, the gap is liability clarity in P4. Closing it with evidence and rules is where the PSP adds the most value.

Ratings are JPMMS judgment for discussion, informed by public documentation and the Crossmint sample-app review. Not survey data.

We should win shopper-confirmed checkout now, differentiate in delegated purchasing, partner with agent wallets and defend against browser agents



Differentiate · P4, P5

Where authority matters most and where bank-backed consent (Chase, Paze), decisioning and evidence are hardest to copy. Our target experience.

Win now · P2

Live volume today. Table stakes for any PSP, so we must be at parity: hosted UCP, Google Pay, agent labels, smarter authentication.

Partner · P3

Agent wallets are fast and already bring traffic. Make them a credential source in our orchestration rather than compete.

Defend · P1

Already hitting our merchants as unlabelled card payments. Detect agent signals in UPOP so good agents aren't declined as bots, and steer them to the API path.

Watch · P6

Track stablecoin and account-to-account agent payments; revisit when card or bank rails are in play.

Placement is qualitative JPMMS judgment for discussion.

Our right to win: we already run most of the stack on both sides of the payment. Four new components turn it into the agent execution layer

ACQUIRING SIDE · WE RUN TODAY

UPOP	Routing, authorization, capture, settlement, reconciliation
Credential Vault	Network tokens, account updater, card-on-file lifecycle
Authentication Optimization	Exemptions, 3DS, passkeys; the step-up decision
Decision Platform	Real-time policy and risk decisions
PIIR / PPI and BIN Intelligence	Card, issuer and debit-routing intelligence
Payment resource model	Order, payment, session and attempt objects

WHAT'S MISSING

Agent identity
Who is this agent, and is it verified?

Delegation
What may it spend, where, until when?

Agentic credential orchestration
Which eligible credential pays?

Evidence
Can we prove what was allowed?

ISSUER AND CREDENTIAL SIDE · WITHIN JPMORGAN

Chase cards and app	A trusted place for consumers to grant, limit and revoke agent authority
Chase as issuer	Issuer authentication; early certification of agentic tokens
Paze	Bank-owned wallet with cards preloaded by issuers; a credential no platform controls
Treasury and settlement	Enterprise merchants keep money movement under one roof

Guardrails: any use of issuer data in acquiring needs legal and compliance sign-off. Paze is governed by EWS and its seven owner banks; JPM can sponsor but not decide.

WHO SPANS WHAT (PUBLIC POSITIONING)	AGENT SURFACE	PROTOCOL	AGENT CREDENTIAL	ISSUER CONSENT	ACQUIRING	EVIDENCE FOR DISPUTES
Stripe today	○	●	●	○	●	◔
Google today	●	●	◕	○	○	◑
Visa, Mastercard today	○	◕	●	◑	○	◑
JPMorgan today	○	○	◔	◔	●	◔
JPMorgan target	○	◑	◕	●	●	●

Portfolio assets as named internally. Competitor ratings are JPMMS judgment from public positioning only; both JPMorgan rows shown.

Any agent purchase made on someone's behalf needs eight building blocks. In plain terms, this is what each one does

1
Consumer wallet

Where the person's cards live and where they say yes.

Like: your physical wallet
Who: Paze, Google Pay, Chase app

2
AI agent

Software that understands the request, finds products and places the order.

Like: a personal shopper
Who: Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude, Instinct

3
Permission slip

The limits the person sets: how much, where, for how long. It can be changed or torn up at any time.

Like: a signed letter of authority
Who: our gateway (delegation)

4
Agentic token provider

Issues a stand-in card number only this agent can use, with a one-time code for each purchase.

Like: a key that opens one door, once
Who: Visa, Mastercard, Paze

5
Common language

Agreed formats so agents, merchants and payment providers understand each other.

Like: shipping labels everyone can read
Who: UCP, ACP, AP2, TAP, MCP

6
Trust gateway

Checks the agent is genuine and the purchase is inside the permission, picks the right card, and keeps the receipt.

Like: a bank teller checking the letter
Who: JPMMS Agent Commerce Gateway

7
Decision engine

Scores risk and applies the rules in milliseconds: approve, ask the person, or decline.

Like: the fraud desk
Who: JPMMS Decision Platform

8
Payment rails and merchant

Moves the money, gets the bank's approval, settles, and ships the goods.

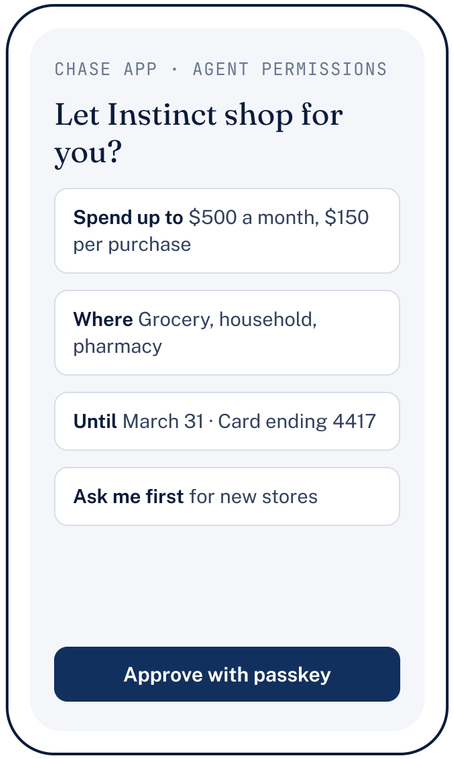
Like: the road and the store
Who: UPOP, Visa and Mastercard, issuers, merchants

Most players today have three or four of these. Agent apps have 2 and 5; wallets have 1 and sometimes 4; networks have 4; PSPs have 8. The permission slip (3) and the trust gateway (6) are what nobody provides end to end, and they are exactly what a bank-owned PSP is built for.

Simplified for a mixed audience; technical names appear on the architecture pages.

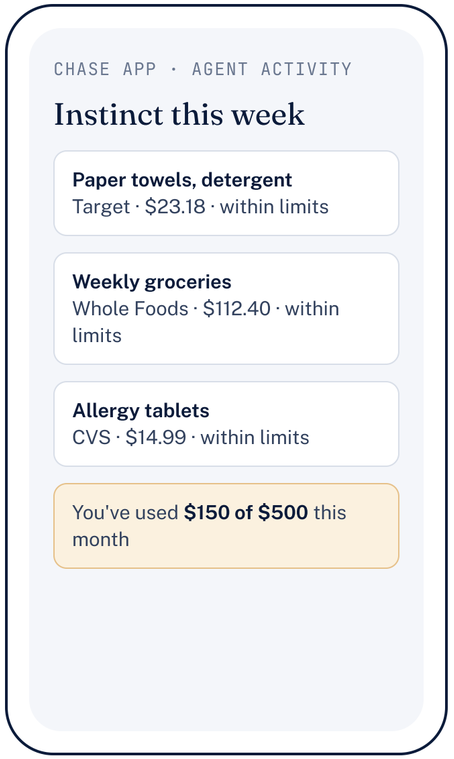
The target experience: set limits once in a trusted app, then let the agent shop silently. The consumer acts only when authority is created or exceeded

1 Delegate once
Consumer acts



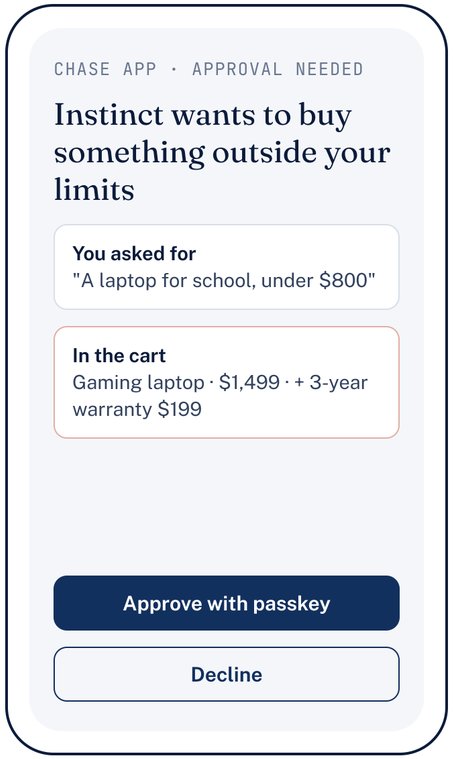
The gateway records the permission; the network issues an agent-only token. The agent never sees the card.

2 Shop silently
No action needed



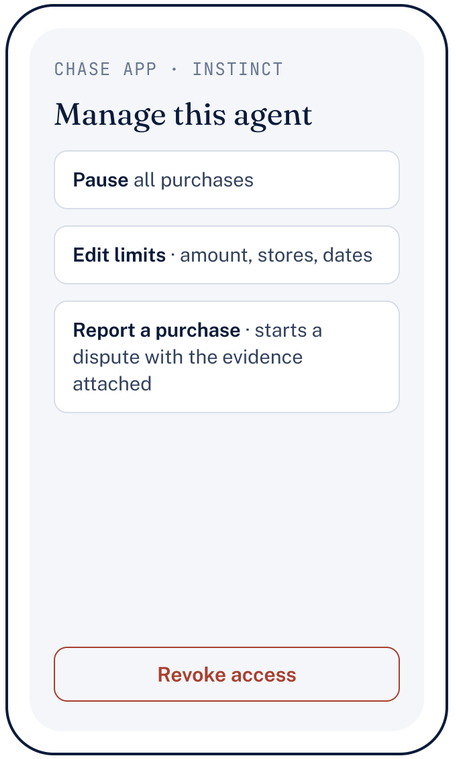
Each purchase is checked against the permission and risk, paid with a single-use code, and logged as evidence.

3 Approve exceptions
One tap, only when needed



Showing the request next to the cart is also the best defence against a manipulated agent.

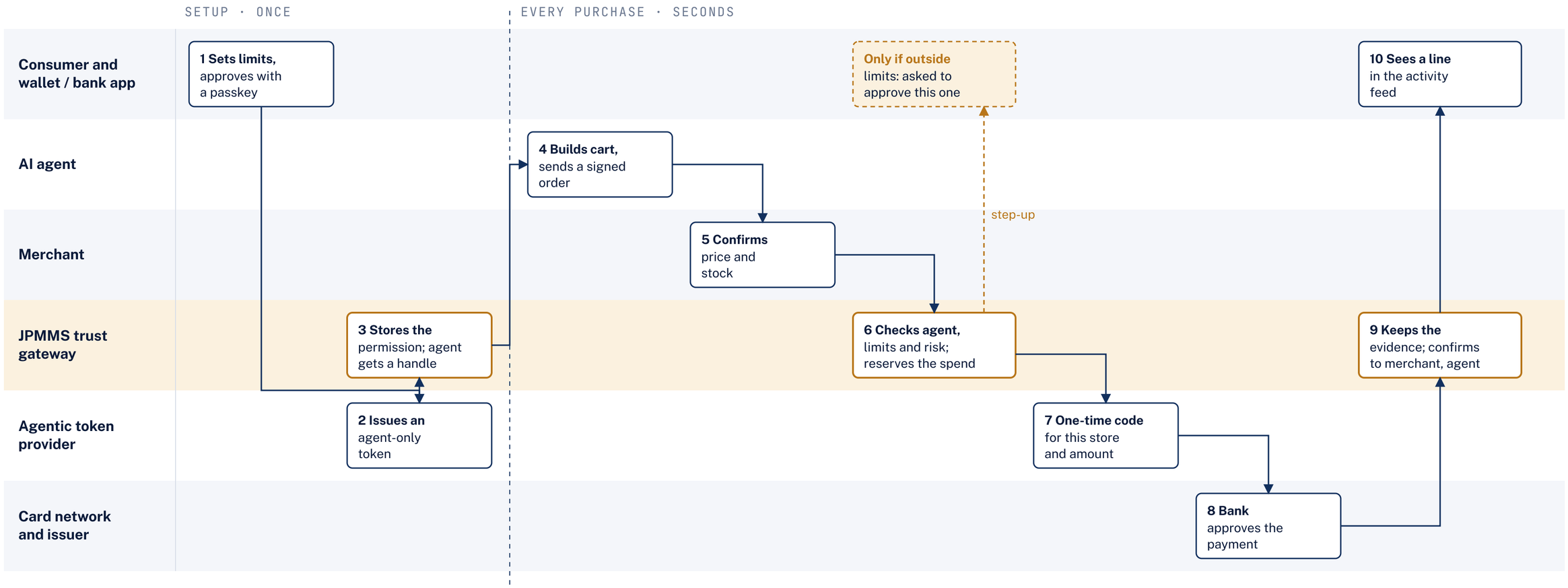
4 Stay in control
Any time



Revoking switches off every agent token at once, so later agent charges are declined; anything not yet submitted is cancelled.

Illustrative screens. Brand, copy and placement inside each issuer's app, or inside Paze, are for issuers and EWS to decide.

How the parts talk: one setup, then a few machine-to-machine checks on every purchase, with the consumer pulled in only for exceptions



Card details never reach the agent. Steps 6–9 run in the background; the agent only receives "approved", "declined" or "ask the consumer".

Plain-language view of the gateway purchase flow. Protocol calls (UCP, ACP, AP2, TAP) carry steps 4–5 and 9; token and cryptogram calls carry steps 2 and 7.

There are three ways a consumer can authorize an agent. Each proves something different, needs different credentials and carries different liability

	MODE A Shopper confirms checkout	MODE B Consumer approves one purchase	MODE C Agent buys under a delegation
Who is present	Shopper, at checkout	Consumer, for one tap	Nobody
Looks like	Gemini checkout with the Google Pay sheet; ChatGPT checkout; Paze checkout	A step-up in the bank app; an AP2 cart mandate; a per-purchase budget	A permission set once in the bank app, Paze or network consent
What it proves	The shopper confirmed this checkout	The consumer approved this exact cart and amount	The agent had authority; **not** that it chose what the consumer wanted
Eligible credentials	Wallet tokens; saved cards. Google Pay PAN_ONLY counts as card-not-present	Agentic tokens, single-use virtual cards, Paze agent path once live	Only credentials marked eligible for unattended use, with limits enforced by the network or issuer
Liability today	Existing wallet rules. Device-authenticated tokens may shift fraud to the issuer; PAN_ONLY does not	Fraud: authenticated-token rules. Wrong purchase: unassigned	No network agent rule yet; contractual in our pilot
Available	LIVE NOW	PILOTING	PILOTING our Phase 2

How modes map to the six patterns: mode A covers P2; mode B covers P3 and any step-up inside P4; mode C covers P4 and P5.

> **The rule we hold to:** no mode upgrades into another by implication. A confirmed Google Pay checkout or a saved card is never permission for the agent to buy again unattended. Mode C always starts with an explicit permission from the consumer.

Liability statements reflect current network rules as publicly described; agent-specific rules are not yet published. Not legal advice.

Our product architecture: one Agent Commerce Gateway on top of platforms we already run. Most of it is reuse or extension; four components are new

Agents and partners Outside JPM	**AI agents** Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude, Instinct	**Wallets** Paze, Google Pay, Chase app	**Token providers** Visa, Mastercard, Paze	**Merchants** JPMMS merchants and platforms
1 · Entry points Speak every protocol	**UCP and AP2 adapter** Google agent checkout, mandates	**ACP adapter** OpenAI checkout	**TAP and Agent Pay checks** Is this a real, registered agent?	**MCP server and API** Any agent host
2 · Agent Commerce Gateway Owns the transaction record	**Agent identity** Registry mirror, keys, agent risk	**Delegation** Limits, versions, revocation, spend reservation	**Payment resources** Order, intent, attempt and authorization record	**Evidence** Tamper-evident record for disputes
3 · Decision Platform Is it allowed?	**Delegation policy** New decision use case	**Agent and merchant risk** New risk layers	**Transaction risk** Existing models	**Step-up decision** When to ask the consumer
4 · Credentials and authentication How can it be paid?	**Agentic orchestration** Picks an eligible credential every time	**Credential Vault** Agentic tokens; Google Pay to network token	**Authentication Optimization** Passkeys, SPA, 3DS	**PIIR and BIN Intelligence** Card and routing data
5 · UPOP and acquiring Execute and settle	**Routing and authorization** Existing	**Agent indicators** Labels on every attempt	**Capture and settlement** Existing	**Reconciliation and reporting** Existing

LEGEND

- NEW 4 components + protocol adapters
- EXTEND existing platform, new capability
- REUSE as is
- PARTNER outside JPM

THE ONE RULE

The gateway keeps the record. The Decision Platform decides. Orchestration executes. Adapters never decide; the optimizer never overrides a consumer's limit.

FOR ARCHITECTS

Logical layers, not five new services. One canonical agent context for every protocol; an immutable decision record per attempt; spend reserved atomically; authority checks fail closed.

Detail in the Agent Commerce Gateway design (v3): Sections 6, 8, 9 and 12.

We build only where control of authority and evidence is the product, extend what we run, and partner for everything consumers or networks own

CAPABILITY	DECISION	WHY	WITH WHOM
Agent experience and app	PARTNER	Not our business; distribution belongs to agent platforms	Google, OpenAI, Anthropic, Instinct, Meta and Sierra
Commerce protocols	ADOPT, SHAPE	Standards decide reach; shaping them protects PSP neutrality	UCP, ACP, AP2 (FIDO Alliance), PAP workshops, EMVCo
Agent identity and registries	PARTNER BUILD	Networks run registries; we verify and score agents ourselves	Visa TAP directory, Mastercard Agent Pay registry
Delegation and consent record	BUILD	The core of the product; must stay credential-neutral	Consent screens with Chase app, Paze and network consent
Agentic tokens and cryptograms	PARTNER	Issued by networks and wallets	Visa Intelligent Commerce, Mastercard Agent Pay, Paze, Google Pay
Policy and risk decisions	EXTEND	Decision Platform already decides in real time; add agent use cases	Internal
Credential vault and lifecycle	EXTEND	Add agentic tokens and eligibility rules to Credential Vault	Internal; network token services
Authentication	EXTEND	Add passkeys and SPA to Authentication Optimization	Google (SPA), networks (passkeys), issuers
Evidence and disputes	BUILD	No one owns it; it is how liability gets settled	Networks and issuers to recognise the format
Routing, acquiring, settlement	REUSE	UPOP does this today	Internal
Agent wallets	PARTNER	Already bring agent traffic; treat as a credential source	Crossmint, Link and similar
PayFac and merchant of record	LATER	Separate propositions with their own risk models; not needed to launch	MoR partners evaluated in Phase 4

Build = JPMMS owns and operates. Extend = existing JPMMS platform gains a capability. Partner = external party supplies it under agreement.

Nine partner relationships make the ecosystem work. In each we ask for something specific and offer something only JPMorgan can bring

Google

PHASE 1

ROLE
Agent surface (Gemini, AI Mode), UCP, Google Pay, SPA, AP2

WE ASK
Gateway listing as UCP payment handler; production review path; US SPA pilot

WE OFFER
Enterprise merchants agent-ready by configuration; better approvals on Google Pay

Visa

PHASE 1–2

ROLE
TAP agent directory; Intelligent Commerce tokens; network rules

WE ASK
Early acquirer certification; liability sandbox for the evidence bundle

WE OFFER
Labelled agent volume and loss data from issuer and acquirer

Mastercard

PHASE 2

ROLE
Agent Pay tokens and registry; network rules

WE ASK
Agent Pay certification; work on an agent misexecution reason code

WE OFFER
The same data and evidence, network-neutral

EWS · Paze

PHASE 1 TRACK

ROLE
Bank-owned wallet; consent and revocation in the bank app

WE ASK
Agent use of today's Paze checkout; the Paze Agent API proposal

WE OFFER
One PSP integration instead of one per agent; first live agent volume

OpenAI

PHASE 2

ROLE
ChatGPT surface; ACP co-owner

WE ASK
Recognition as an ACP payment provider; one merchant pilot

WE OFFER
Enterprise merchants without forcing a Stripe integration

Agent platform pilot

PHASE 2

ROLE
A personal-shopping agent (for example Instinct) as first delegated-purchase partner

WE ASK
Gateway-hosted delegation; agent indemnity in the pilot contract

WE OFFER
Bank-backed consent and better approvals than one-time cards

Anthropic

PHASE 2–3

ROLE
Claude agents; MCP; a commerce blueprint that leaves payments to partners

WE ASK
Named payments partner; gateway module in the blueprint

WE OFFER
A ready execution layer for Claude-built commerce agents

Meta and Sierra

PHASE 4

ROLE
PAP, the agent-to-business protocol; brand agents

WE ASK
A seat in the payments-extension workshops

WE OFFER
A PSP-neutral payments design instead of a Stripe default

Agent wallets

PHASE 2–3

ROLE
Crossmint and similar, already moving agent traffic

WE ASK
Route through our gateway and APIs, not browser automation

WE OFFER
Merchant-sanctioned path, agent labels, evidence, better approvals

Expect non-exclusivity: we win on approvals, consent quality and dispute outcomes. Instinct is a personal-shopping agent app; Sierra builds customer-facing agents for brands.

Paze view: a bank-owned wallet gives consumers a trusted place to grant and revoke agent authority. We start with today's Paze and grow into delegation

PHASE 1 · TODAY'S PAZE **Shopper-confirmed agent checkout (mode A)** uses existing Paze checkout APIs; EWS to confirm agent-surface use

AI AGENT
Builds the cart
Through a merchant's UCP or ACP checkout hosted by JPMMS

→

CONSUMER · PAZE
Picks a card, confirms
In the Paze checkout, with cards already loaded by their bank

→

JPMMS GATEWAY
Labels and checks
Agent context, risk, authentication

→

JPMMS UPOP
Decrypts and authorizes
Existing Paze payload on the existing path

→

NETWORK AND ISSUER
Approves
Network token and cryptogram, as today

PHASE 2 IF EWS CERTIFIES IN TIME, ELSE PHASE 3 · PAZE AGENT API **Headless delegated purchasing (mode C)** needs EWS to agree and certify new interfaces

CONSUMER · BANK APP OR PAZE
Delegates once
Limits, stores, dates; passkey at the issuer

→

PAZE · NEW API
Agent-bound token
Provisioned for this agent and delegation

→

JPMMS GATEWAY
Checks every purchase
Permission, risk, spend reservation, evidence

→

PAZE · NEW API
One-time payload
For this merchant and amount, with Paze risk signals

→

JPMMS UPOP
Authorizes, settles
Agent indicators carried to the network

WHY PAZE IS DIFFERENT

- Consent and revocation in the consumer's own bank app
- Cards preloaded by issuers: no card typing for agents
- A credential no tech platform controls

WHAT IS NOT THERE YET

- No headless path: Paze checkout assumes the consumer is present
- The Paze Agent API is our proposal (15 endpoints, 7 for a pilot), not agreed
- EWS is owned by seven banks; JPM sponsors, cannot decide

HOW WE HANDLE IT

- Paze is in Phase 1 in its current form
- The agent path joins as a pilot arm when certified
- No release gate waits on EWS; the gateway stays credential-neutral

Decision needed: sponsor the Paze Agent API proposal at EWS now, with JPM-issued cards and one agent platform as the pilot scope. If EWS agrees, Paze becomes the first bank-owned credential built for agents.

Red dashed boxes need new EWS interfaces. Detail: Paze Agent API Specification and Gap Analysis.

Google view: Gemini and AI Mode traffic reaches merchants through UCP. We win by being the best payment handler behind it, then add mandates for delegation

PHASE 1 · LIVE TODAY **Shopper confirms in Google Pay (mode A)**

SHOPPER · GEMINI OR AI MODE
Asks, chooses
Agent finds the product at the merchant

→

JPMMS-HOSTED UCP
Merchant checkout
Profile, cart and order on the merchant's behalf

→

GOOGLE PAY SHEET
Shopper confirms
Encrypted token for JPMMS as gateway

→

JPMMS GATEWAY
Decrypt, label, authenticate
Device token, or step-up: SPA where available, passkey, 3DS

→

JPMMS UPOP
Authorize, settle
Saved cards become network tokens for repeat checkout

→

NETWORK AND ISSUER
Approves
As for any wallet payment

PHASE 2–4 · NEXT **From confirmed checkout to delegation and multi-merchant carts**

PHASE 2 · AP2 MANDATES
Verify what the user signed
Check mandates against the actual cart; link to a gateway delegation for unattended buying

PHASE 3 · AUTHENTICATION
SPA in the ladder where live
Tested against passkeys and 3DS; US use depends on Google

PHASE 4 · UNIVERSAL CART
One intent, many merchants
One consent record across split authorizations at JPMMS merchants

GOOGLE COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES	STATUS, OCT 2026	HONEST CONSTRAINT	OUR PLAY
UCP	Agent-to-merchant checkout protocol	LIVE in Gemini and AI Mode	Merchant, not agent, picks the PSP	Host endpoints; own the merchant relationship
Google Pay	Wallet credential inside UCP	LIVE	Saved-account cards (PAN_ONLY) carry no liability shift; our policy keeps them out of unattended buying	Token intelligence; step-up where it pays
SPA	On-device biometric instead of a 3DS challenge	LIMITED UK and Poland, Android	Not available in the US	Capability-gated arm; ask for a US pilot
AP2	Signed user mandates	EARLY FIDO Alliance governs	A signature proves what was signed, not that the purchase was right	Verify and keep as evidence

Source: Google Pay for UCP developer documentation; Adyen and Checkout.com documentation on SPA; Google announcements. Detail: Google Rails for the JPMC PSP.

Build, learn, then widen the circle: four phases, each adding partners and each funded only when its gate is passed

	PHASE 1 Agent-ready acceptance	PHASE 2 Controlled delegated purchasing	PHASE 3 Optimize and prove the evidence	PHASE 4 Enterprise scale and expansion
Experience we enable	Shopper-confirmed agent checkout (mode A) at JPMMS merchants	Consumer delegates once; agent buys within limits (modes B and C)	Best credential and authentication chosen per purchase	Recurring at scale, multi-merchant carts, more agents and protocols
What we build	Agent labels in UPOP; hosted UCP; Google Pay in UCP; TAP checks; MCP server; Evidence v1	Delegation, spend reservation, credential eligibility, step-up, evidence; first subscription authorizations; ACP; AP2 checks	Routing, credential and authentication experiments; SPA where live; evidence with networks	PAP adapter; evidence and risk as products; debit routing for agents
Partners added	**Google**, **Visa** (TAP), **EWS** (Paze checkout), first enterprise merchants	**Visa, Mastercard** agentic tokens; **one agent platform**; **OpenAI**; Paze Agent API arm if certified	Networks and issuers on the evidence bundle; **Anthropic**; agent wallets; Paze agent path	**Meta and Sierra**; more agent platforms; MoR partners and platform PayFacs evaluated
What we learn	How much agent traffic we already carry; baseline approval, fraud, latency	Do consumers delegate from the bank app? Do approvals beat one-time cards?	Does optimization add value against controls? Does evidence win disputes?	Unit economics and loss rates at scale
Exit gate	**Reliable processing, correct labels, clean reconciliation**	**Limits enforced under load; fraud within guardrails**	**Incremental value shown; controls independently validated**	**Contribution margin, retention, risk-adjusted growth**
PAZE TRACK	**Today's Paze checkout** in agent checkout; Agent API proposal to EWS	**Paze Agent API arm**, only if EWS agrees and certifies in time	**Paze agent path** once interfaces and governance are agreed	**All participating issuers**, delegation in each bank app
GOOGLE TRACK	**Hosted UCP + Google Pay**; agent labels; baseline on Gemini traffic	**AP2 mandate checks** linked to gateway delegations	**SPA arm** where available; tokenization of saved cards	**Universal Cart**: one consent across merchants
The learning loop, every phase	**1 Build** the smallest slice that real agents and merchants can use	**2 Measure** on labelled traffic against a control group	**3 Decide** at the gate: scale, fix or stop	**4 Widen** the circle: bring in the next partners with evidence in hand

No dates are committed before the Phase 1 gate. No gate depends on EWS. Detail: Agent Commerce Gateway design (v3), Section 19.

Liability follows control. Fraud largely follows existing card rules; the authorized-but-wrong purchase does not, and that is where we lead

WHAT GOES WRONG	WHO SHOULD BEAR IT	IN OUR PILOT (BY CONTRACT)	TARGET (NETWORK RULE)
Stolen card, compromised agent or hijacked delegation	**Issuer**, if authenticated otherwise merchant, as today	Existing rules (as with 3DS); JPM as issuer only once a joint position is agreed	Agentic liability shift for the evidence bundle
Approved outside the consumer's limits	**Policy owner** gateway or Paze	JPMMS indemnifies pilot merchants	Delegations and mandates recognized in network rules
Agent misread the instruction: wrong item, add-ons	**Agent platform**	Agent indemnity in the pilot agreement	"Agent misexecution" reason code routed to the agent's sponsor
Not delivered, or not as described	**Merchant**	Existing reason codes	Unchanged
Matched the instruction; consumer changed their mind	**Consumer**	Merchant returns policy	Merchant-set terms for agent orders

CANDIDATE LIABILITY-SHIFT BUNDLE · ASSEMBLED FOR EVERY TRANSACTION

- Consumer-authenticated delegation
- Registered, signed agent
- Policy decision recorded
- Cart integrity verified
- Cryptogram bound to merchant and amount
- Agent indicator in authorization

OUR APPROACH, IN FOUR STEPS

1. **Pilot under contract** with merchants, the agent and JPM as issuer
2. **Record the evidence bundle** for every transaction
3. **Take the data** to Visa, Mastercard and EMVCo to shape rules
4. **Offer an agent transaction guarantee**, priced from pilot losses, while rules are unsettled

STATE OF PLAY · OCTOBER 2026

- No agent-specific reason codes; merchants absorb misexecution by default
- Commentators read Reg E (debit) as presuming consent once credentials are handed to an agent; Reg Z governs credit
- First binding network rule likely no earlier than the April 2027 cycle; EMVCo task force under way
- Reports on Visa's April 2026 rules conflict; verify before relying on them

Align inside JPM first. An issuer-side shift helps JPMMS merchants and costs Chase as issuer. Agree one JPMMS–Chase position before engaging networks or EMVCo.

Liability positions are hypotheses for pilot contracts, not legal advice. Sources: Worldpay, Chargeflow, TinyFish and Shopappy commentary, cited in the gateway design (v3), Section 16.

Nine issues we must manage. None blocks Phase 1, and each has a mitigation and an owner

ISSUE	SEVERITY	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW WE HANDLE IT	OWNER
Paze Agent API not agreed	HIGH	No headless Paze path today; EWS decides with seven banks	Paze in Phase 1 in today's form; agent path is a gated arm; no gate depends on EWS	Product, with EWS relationship lead
Saved Google Pay cards (PAN_ONLY)	MEDIUM	No liability shift; a saved card is not consent for unattended buying	Treat as card-not-present; network tokens for repeat checkout only; step-up where it pays	Credential Vault and authentication
Google SPA not in the US	LOW	Cannot be the default step-up method	Capability-gated arm; UK first; ask Google for a US pilot	Authentication Optimization
Protocol churn	MEDIUM	ACP has changed fast; PAP has no spec; UCP and PAP overlap	Thin adapters, one canonical agent context, versioned and isolated	Gateway architecture
No agent liability rules	HIGH	Merchants absorb wrong purchases; consumer-protection reading is unsettled	Pilot contracts, evidence bundle, network engagement, priced guarantee	Risk, legal, network relations
JPMMS and Chase interests diverge	HIGH	An issuer shift helps merchants, costs the issuer	Agree one position before any network forum	Joint JPMMS–Chase steering
Browser agents bypass the PSP	MEDIUM	Agent traffic arrives unlabelled and is declined as bots	Detect and label in UPOP; steer to the API path	UPOP and fraud
Issuer data in acquiring decisions	MEDIUM	Regulatory and data-use limits	Start with certification and shared fraud labels; legal review before design	Legal and compliance
Stripe's head start	HIGH	ACP, Link and onboarding already in market	Compete on issuer consent, evidence and multi-acquirer enterprise needs	Strategy and sales

Full threat and failure matrix: Agent Commerce Gateway design (v3), Section 14.

What we want to do, and what it gets us: Phase 1 approved in principle, five partner conversations, and one bank-wide liability position

WHAT WE ARE ASKING THIS GROUP TO APPROVE

1. **Approve Phase 1 in principle**
   Agent labels, hosted UCP, Google Pay in UCP, TAP checks, MCP server, evidence v1. Name a team for the protocol adapters; cost, headcount and target window come back for sign-off.

2. **Open five partner conversations**
   Google (handler listing), Visa and Mastercard (certification, liability sandbox), EWS (Paze), one agent platform.

3. **Agree one JPMMS–Chase liability position**
   Before Visa, Mastercard or EMVCo forums.

4. **Start legal review**
   Issuer-data use, mandate and instruction retention, consumer-protection exposure.

NEXT 90 DAYS

- Label agent traffic already in UPOP and publish a baseline
- Ship the gateway as an MCP server and UCP payment handler for pilot merchants
- Table the Paze Agent API proposal at EWS; name the pilot agent
- Join the PAP payments-extension workshops

WHAT IT GETS US, BY AUDIENCE

Business

- Agent orders settle with JPMMS, not another PSP
- New fees: gateway, decisioning, evidence, agent guarantee
- Enterprise retention: one integration for every agent

Strategy

- A position Stripe and Adyen can't copy alone: issuer consent plus acquiring
- A seat where agent liability rules get written
- Partners on every major agent platform without picking a winner

Product

- "Agent-ready" becomes a merchant setting, not a project
- A consumer experience with control in the bank app
- First-party data to tune approvals, step-up and fraud

Architecture and technology

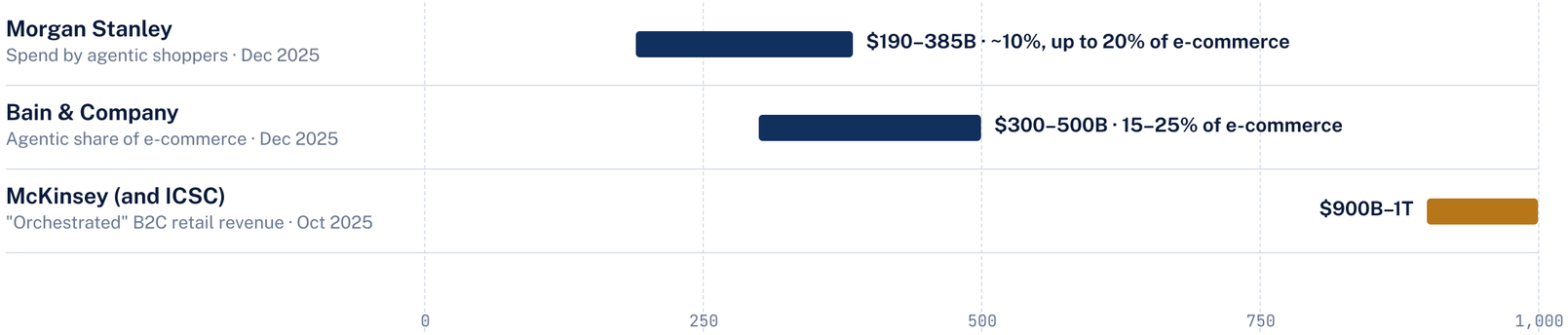
- Reuses UPOP, Credential Vault, Decision Platform and Authentication Optimization
- Four new components behind stable contracts
- Protocol churn contained in adapters

Cost of waiting: Stripe, Adyen and Checkout.com already support Google agent checkout. Merchants choose the payment handler, so every merchant that turns on agent checkout elsewhere first is harder to win back.

Phase 1 cost, headcount and timing are to be sized for sign-off; financial targets are set from the Phase 1 baseline. No revenue figure is committed here.

Appendix · Market sizing: published forecasts put US agentic commerce at roughly $190B to $1T by 2030, depending on what counts as "agentic"

US AGENTIC COMMERCE BY 2030, PUBLISHED FORECASTS ($ BILLIONS)



GLOBAL, 2030

$3–5T agent-orchestrated goods revenue (McKinsey, Oct 2025) · **$1.5T** agentic commerce spend (Juniper Research, Apr 2026)

THE BASE IT DRAWS FROM

US retail e-commerce ran **$340.2B in Q2 2026** (seasonally adjusted), 17.1% of retail: about **$1.36T a year** at that run rate (US Census Bureau)

Why the spread: Morgan Stanley and Bain count purchases agents make or complete; McKinsey counts revenue agents "orchestrate", which includes agent-assisted buying. For a PSP, the narrower figures are closer to payment volume that moves through agent channels.

Caution: forecasts were made in late 2025 and early 2026 with undisclosed models, and influence metrics are not completed agent purchases. Use as direction, not a target.

LEADING INDICATORS, ALREADY MEASURABLE

+693%	Year-on-year growth in generative-AI referral traffic to US retail sites, 2025 holiday season (Adobe)
+31%	Higher conversion of AI-referred visitors than other traffic over the same period (Adobe)
>20%	Share of global online holiday sales influenced by AI and agents, 2025 (Salesforce estimate)
$3B	US Black Friday 2025 sales influenced by AI and agents (Salesforce, cited by Bain)
~23%	Americans estimated to have bought something via AI in the past month (Morgan Stanley, Dec 2025)

WHAT IT MEANS FOR JPMMS · ILLUSTRATIVE

On the Morgan Stanley and Bain range of **$190–500B**, each 1% share of US agentic volume is **$1.9–5B** a year of payment volume. Most early volume is shopper-confirmed checkout (P2), where we compete as processor.

Sources: Morgan Stanley Research (8 Dec 2025); Bain & Company snap chart (17 Dec 2025); McKinsey, "The agentic commerce opportunity" (17 Oct 2025); Retail Dive on ICSC and McKinsey (5 May 2026); Juniper Research via FinTech Futures (7 Apr 2026); Adobe Analytics (Jan 2026); Digital Commerce 360 (13 Jan 2026); US Census Bureau Q2 2026 e-commerce report (18 Aug 2026).

Appendix · How we will measure success: seven dimensions every phase, not approval rate alone

DIMENSION	PRIMARY MEASURES
Consumer authority	Unauthorized execution rate, policy violations, time to propagate a revocation
Payment performance	Approval and decline rates, retry recovery, end-to-end latency (p50, p95, p99)
Risk	Fraud basis points, misexecution rate, dispute rate and outcomes
Consumer experience	Delegation conversion, 30- and 90-day retention, step-up completion and abandonment
Merchant adoption	Time to agent-ready, activation rate, repeat agent orders
Economics	Incremental volume, contribution margin, cost per transaction, loss and servicing cost
Platform quality	Protocol conformance, credential eligibility failures, evidence completeness, reconciliation breaks

EXPERIMENT	PHASE	COMPARES
E1 Approval	2	Issuer-authenticated agentic token vs Link one-time card
E2 Fraud	2	Same split as E1, over a full dispute window
E3 Delegation	2	Bank-app consent vs agent-hosted consent
E4 Step-up	2	Two threshold settings, above a fixed guardrail floor
E5 Merchant	1	Gateway-configured vs bespoke agent integration
E6 Evidence	3	Fighting disputes (representment) with vs without the evidence package
E7 Optimization	3	Credential, authentication and routing strategies vs a fixed default
E8 Incremental value	3	Gateway agent orders vs existing checkout and virtual cards

> Each experiment sets its baseline, control group, observation period and stop rule before launch.

Detail: Agent Commerce Gateway design (v3), Sections 17 and 21.

Appendix · Protocols and terms in plain language

PROTOCOL	IN PLAIN LANGUAGE	BACKED BY
UCP	How an agent browses a store, builds a cart and checks out	Google, Shopify
ACP	OpenAI's checkout standard for buying inside ChatGPT	OpenAI, Stripe
AP2	Signed "permission slips" proving what the user authorized	Google; FIDO Alliance
TAP	Lets a merchant check an agent is registered and genuine	Visa, Cloudflare
Agent Pay	Mastercard's agent tokens and agent registry	Mastercard
MCP	How an agent plugs into tools and APIs	Created by Anthropic; open standard
PAP	How an agent signs in to a company and acts on an account	Meta, Sierra
A2A	How agents talk to other agents	Google; Linux Foundation
x402	Pay-per-request over the web, usually in stablecoins	Coinbase

TERM	IN PLAIN LANGUAGE
Delegation	The consumer's standing permission: how much, where, until when
Agentic token	A stand-in card number that only one agent can use
Cryptogram	A one-time code proving this payment came from that token
Step-up	Asking the consumer to approve one purchase, usually with a passkey
PAN_ONLY	A Google Pay card saved in the Google account, not on the device; weaker proof
SPA	Google's on-device biometric check, used instead of a 3DS challenge
Misexecution	The agent had permission but bought the wrong thing
Liability shift	A rule that moves fraud losses from merchant to issuer when proof is strong
PSP, PayFac, MoR	Processor; a processor that onboards sub-merchants; the legal seller
Our platforms	UPOP: payment orchestration · Credential Vault: stored cards and tokens · Decision Platform: real-time risk and policy · PIIR: card intelligence · EWS: Early Warning Services, which runs Paze